

CENTRAL BOARD OF SECONDARY EDUCATION — PRACTICE EXAMINATION**CLASS IX • SOCIAL SCIENCE (SUBJECT CODE: 087) • ACADEMIC SESSION 2026-27****SET F — RAPID FIRE SPEED TEST (30 MINS)****CHAPTER 04: EARLY HUMANS AND BEGINNING OF CIVILISATION**

TIME ALLOWED: 30 MINUTES

MAXIMUM MARKS: 25 MARKS

SERIES: CBS-IX-SST-SET-F-04

Student's Name: _____

Roll No.: _____

Class & Section: Class IX - _____

Date of Exam: _____

Invigilator's Sign: _____

General Instructions (SET F - Rapid Fire Speed Test):

1. The question paper comprises **25 Rapid Fire Multiple Choice Questions** of **1 mark each**.
2. Designed for **Rapid Recall & High-Speed Accuracy**: Recommended target time is **30 Minutes**.
3. All questions are compulsory. There is no negative marking.
4. Darken the corresponding bubble on the **OMR Sheet** completely using a blue/black ballpoint pen.

⚡ SPEED CHALLENGE INSTRUCTIONS: Answer promptly without looking at notes. Test your instant recall of historical milestones, geographic terms, constitutional provisions, and core economic laws!

Q.1 The earliest and longest technological period of human prehistoric tool-making is the:

- (A) Neolithic era (B) Palaeolithic (Old Stone Age)
(C) Bronze Age (D) Iron Age

Q.2 Tiny, finely flaked geometric stone blades hafted onto wood or bone handles during the Mesolithic period are called:

- (A) Hand-axes (B) Microliths
(C) Celts (D) Iron chisels

Q.3 The fundamental economic transformation from food-gathering to food-producing (agriculture) occurred during the:

- (A) Palaeolithic era (B) Neolithic era (New Stone Age)
(C) Mesolithic era (D) Copper Age

Q.4 Which archaeological site in Madhya Pradesh is world-famous for its prehistoric painted rock shelters spanning 500+ caves?

- (A) Lothal (B) Bhimbetka
(C) Mehrgarh (D) Taxila

Q.5 Which site in Baluchistan provides one of the earliest archaeological evidences of farming (wheat/barley) in South Asia (c. 7000 BCE)?

- (A) Harappa (B) Mehrgarh
(C) Mohenjo-daro (D) Kalibangan

Q.6 The Harappan (Indus Valley) Civilisation is classified chronologically under which technological age?

- (A) Iron Age (B) Bronze Age
(C) Palaeolithic Age (D) Atomic Age

Q.7 What was the standardized dimensional ratio of baked mud-bricks used in Mature Harappan architecture?

- | | |
|---------------|--|
| (A) 1 : 1 : 1 | (B) 1 : 2 : 4 (Thickness : Width : Length) |
| (C) 1 : 3 : 9 | (D) 2 : 4 : 5 |

Q.8 The monumental public structure with gypsum and bitumen waterproofing uncovered at Mohenjo-daro is the:

- | | |
|---------------|----------------|
| (A) Dockyard | (B) Great Bath |
| (C) Signboard | (D) Fire altar |

Q.9 At which Harappan port city in Gujarat did S. R. Rao unearth an engineered kiln-burnt brick tidal dockyard?

- | | |
|----------------|--------------|
| (A) Kalibangan | (B) Lothal |
| (C) Dholavira | (D) Banawali |

Q.10 Which Harappan city in Kutch, Gujarat is famous for its massive rock-cut water reservoirs and unique three-tier urban plan?

- | | |
|----------------|---------------|
| (A) Chanhudaro | (B) Dholavira |
| (C) Rakhigarhi | (D) Ropar |

Q.11 At which Harappan site in Rajasthan have archaeologists discovered evidence of a ploughed agricultural field with furrow marks?

- | | |
|------------------|----------------|
| (A) Lothal | (B) Kalibangan |
| (C) Mohenjo-daro | (D) Kot Diji |

Q.12 Which Harappan manufacturing center was devoted almost entirely to craft production, micro-beads, and shell bangles, with no Citadel?

- | | |
|------------------|----------------|
| (A) Harappa | (B) Chanhudaro |
| (C) Mohenjo-daro | (D) Dholavira |

Q.13 The famous bronze figurine known as the 'Dancing Girl' from Mohenjo-daro was cast using which metallurgical technique?

- | | |
|--------------------------|--|
| (A) Iron forging | (B) Lost-wax (cire perdue) casting technique |
| (C) Stone chisel carving | (D) Electroplating |

Q.14 What mineral material was predominantly used to carve the standard square intaglio Harappan stamp seals?

- | | |
|----------------|--------------------------|
| (A) Granite | (B) Steatite (soapstone) |
| (C) Solid gold | (D) Cast iron |

Q.15 In ancient Mesopotamian cuneiform trade records, the Indus Valley / Harappan region was referred to as:

- | | |
|------------|-------------|
| (A) Dilmun | (B) Meluhha |
| (C) Magan | (D) Elam |

Q.16 Harappan chert cubical weights for weighing small luxury items followed which mathematical sequence?

- | | |
|-----------------------------|---|
| (A) Decimal (10, 20, 30...) | (B) Binary progression (1, 2, 4, 8, 16, 32, 64) |
| (C) Fibonacci sequence | (D) Prime numbers |

Q.17 A large ten-character wooden signboard inlaid with white crystalline gypsum symbols was excavated at which city gateway?

- | | |
|------------------|---------------|
| (A) Mohenjo-daro | (B) Dholavira |
| (C) Harappa | (D) Lothal |

Q.18 What animal motif is most frequently engraved on Mature Harappan stamp seals?

- | | |
|---|-------------------------|
| (A) The one-horned mythical unicorn beast | (B) The African giraffe |
| (C) The horse | (D) The polar bear |

Q.19 From which distant Harappan trading outpost in Badakhshan (Afghanistan) was precious blue lapis lazuli procured?

- | | |
|------------------|----------------|
| (A) Shortughai | (B) Lothal |
| (C) Sutkagen Dor | (D) Alamgirpur |

Q.20 From which region in Rajasthan did Harappans procure their copper ores?

- | | |
|-----------------|------------------------|
| (A) Zawar mines | (B) Khetri copper belt |
| (C) Panna mines | (D) Kolar gold fields |

Q.21 What type of mortar was used to seal and waterproof brick masonry in Harappan drains and the Great Bath?

- | | |
|----------------------------|--------------------------|
| (A) Gypsum and lime mortar | (B) Plastic polymer glue |
| (C) Portland cement | (D) Animal fat |

Q.22 The ploughed field and series of clay fire altars were discovered at which Harappan site?

- | | |
|------------------|----------------|
| (A) Mohenjo-daro | (B) Kalibangan |
| (C) Dholavira | (D) Chanhudaro |

Q.23 Why has the Harappan script not yet been successfully deciphered by modern epigraphists?

- | | |
|--|---|
| (A) All Harappan inscriptions were destroyed by modern fires | (B) Inscriptions are very brief (average 5 signs) and no bilingual trilingual Rosetta Stone has ever been found |
| (C) Harappans wrote in modern English | (D) The script was written exclusively on ice that melted |

Q.24 Around what year did the mature urban phase of the Harappan Civilisation experience rapid de-urbanization and decline?

- | | |
|-----------------|-------------------|
| (A) c. 1900 BCE | (B) c. 500 CE |
| (C) c. 1947 CE | (D) c. 10,000 BCE |

Q.25 Which major river system in northwestern India dried up due to tectonic headwater capture, accelerating Harappan decline?

- | | |
|--------------|---|
| (A) Ganga | (B) Ghaggar-Hakra (associated with the ancient Sarasvati) |
| (C) Godavari | (D) Brahmaputra |

CBSE CANDIDATE OMR ANSWER RESPONSE GRID (SET F)

01	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	02	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	03	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	04	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	05	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
06	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	07	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	08	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	09	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	10	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
11	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	12	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	13	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	14	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	15	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
16	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	17	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	18	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	19	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	20	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
21	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	22	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	23	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	24	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	25	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D

Total Questions Attempted: ____ / 25

Marks Obtained: ____ / 25

Evaluator's Signature: _____

OFFICIAL ANSWER KEY & RAPID RECALL EXPLANATIONS (SET F)

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Concept & Rapid Recall Analysis
Q.1	(B)	The Palaeolithic era encompasses over 98% of human technological history, characterized by chipped stone tools.
Q.2	(B)	Microliths are miniature stone blades characteristic of the Mesolithic transitional hunter-gatherer era.
Q.3	(B)	The Neolithic revolution marked the invention of agriculture, animal domestication, pottery, and sedentary villages.
Q.4	(B)	Bhimbetka in Raichur district, MP, features extraordinary prehistoric rock art from Upper Palaeolithic to Mesolithic times.
Q.5	(B)	Mehrgarh on the Kachi plain documented early South Asian transitions from foraging to sedentary farming.
Q.6	(B)	Harappa was an advanced urban Bronze Age civilization; iron technology was completely unknown to Harappans.
Q.7	(B)	Harappan bricks exhibited remarkable standard proportions of 1:2:4 throughout disparate cities from Gujarat to Punjab.
Q.8	(B)	The Great Bath at Mohenjo-daro is an engineered public tank lined with bitumen and gypsum for water retention.
Q.9	(B)	Lothal on the Gulf of Khambhat possessed a tidal dockyard connected by an inlet channel to the Bhogavo river.
Q.10	(B)	Dholavira featured an advanced water-harvesting reservoir circuit and a tripartite city layout (Citadel, Middle, Lower).
Q.11	(B)	Kalibangan yielded a pre-Harappan ploughed field showing grid furrows for simultaneous mixed cropping (mustard and gram).
Q.12	(B)	Chanhudaro was a specialized industrial craft township renowned for bead-making workshops and lack of fortifications.
Q.13	(B)	The Dancing Girl was crafted using lost-wax casting: modeling in wax, encasing in clay, melting wax, and pouring molten bronze.
Q.14	(B)	Harappan seals were carved from soft steatite, engraved with pictograms and animals, and baked to white hardness.
Q.15	(B)	Mesopotamian records designated the Indus region as 'Meluhha', a major source of carnelian, ivory, and lapis lazuli.
Q.16	(B)	Smaller Harappan chert cubical weights followed a binary progression (1, 2, 4, 8, 16, 32, 64), where unit 16 weighed ~13.7g.
Q.17	(B)	The Dholavira Signboard with ten large glyphs was discovered at the northern gateway of the city's Citadel.
Q.18	(A)	The single-horned mythical bull/unicorn motif accounts for over 60% of all zoomorphic engravings on Harappan seals.
Q.19	(A)	Shortughai in northeastern Afghanistan was a dedicated Harappan trading colony situated near lapis lazuli mines.
Q.20	(B)	The Khetri region of Rajasthan was the major copper mining source for the Harappan Civilisation.
Q.21	(A)	Harappans prepared fine gypsum and lime mortar to create watertight seals for public drainage systems.

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Concept & Rapid Recall Analysis
Q.22	(B)	Kalibangan in northern Rajasthan features clay fire altars and early ploughed field furrows.
Q.23	(B)	Decipherment is blocked by brief inscriptional lengths and the total absence of bilingual texts.
Q.24	(A)	Around 1900 BCE, mature Harappan cities entered the Post-Urban decline phase, marked by abandonment of large urban hubs.
Q.25	(B)	The drying of the Ghaggar-Hakra river system starved central Harappan settlements of agricultural water.